Pietro Valetto

PhD Researcher in Social Policy, University of Antwerp

Brussels, Belgium · pietro.valetto@uantwerpen.be · pietrovaletto.github.io · GitHub · LinkedIn · Google Scholar

EDUCATION

University of Antwerp, Centre for Social Policy Herman Deleeck — Antwerp, Belgium
PhD in Social Policy: AI, labour markets and welfare-state financing — Jan 2024 – present

Bocconi University — Milan, Italy
MSc in Economics and Social Sciences (Applied Microeconomics & Welfare Policy) — Sep 2021 – Apr 2024

- Thesis (supervisor: Prof. Z. Parolin): "What Explains Recent Trends in Income Inequality in the European Union?", published in *The Journal of Economic Inequality* (2025).

Bocconi University — Milan, Italy
BSc in International Economics and Management; final grade 100/110 — Aug 2018 – Sep 2021

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of Antwerp, Centre for Social Policy Herman Deleeck — Antwerp, Belgium
PhD Researcher — Jan 2024 – present

- **Generative AI and European workers** (with Prof. Z. Parolin, Oxford): linked EU-SILC microdata to AI-exposure and task-complementarity scores; difference-in-differences on 1.7M workers (2018–2024) around the release of ChatGPT finds a −2.2% income effect for AI-exposed workers, decomposed by complementarity, education, age and gender.
- **"Canaries in the Coal Mine" for Europe:** replication of Brynjolfsson, Chandar & Chen on 6.4M EU-LFS full-time employees (27 countries, 2018–2024); built SOC–ISCO-08 crosswalks for three AI-exposure measures (Eloundou GPT-4 β, Anthropic Economic Index, Felten AIOE); long-difference and event-study estimation with wild-cluster bootstrap.
- **Real estate and wealth concentration:** harmonised Eurosystem HFCS and US SCF household microdata to decompose wealth concentration by asset class (Gini source decomposition, RIF regressions, counterfactual simulation).
- **Asset testing in welfare programmes** (with Prof. I. Marx): cross-national simulation of means-tested benefits in the EU and US using Luxembourg Wealth Study microdata and MISSOC institutional mapping.

European Policy Centre — Brussels, Belgium
Junior Academic Fellow, Social Europe and Wellbeing Programme — Feb 2025 – present

- Lead economic analyst for the policy brief "Fostering AI Resilience in the EU Labour Market" (March 2026): mapped AI exposure across member states and socio-economic groups from linked EU-SILC and EU-LFS data, and drafted seven recommendations for the Commission, including quarterly AI–labour monitoring and welfare-system stress tests against AI-driven tax-base erosion.
- Wrote three Social Europe op-eds (AI and Europe's job market; an EU abundance agenda; poverty and housing under the von der Leyen Commission). Advised senior analysts on social-protection reform and contributed to Strategic Council deliberations.

Future Proof Society × Tortuga — Milan, Italy
Policy Researcher, foresight report on the Draghi agenda — Oct 2025

- Wrote "Do Something! One Year After the Draghi Report" (in Italian): assessed implementation of the 388 Draghi recommendations (11% fully implemented) and the gaps in AI capacity, energy costs, single-market barriers, digital regulation and defence, with priorities for the EU and Italy. Presented to MEPs, ministers and national politicians in Rome.

Bocconi University, ExpPov (ERC project of Prof. Z. Parolin) — Milan, Italy
Research Fellow — Apr 2022 – Jun 2023

- Built a Stata framework to evaluate alternative poverty-line policies on EU-SILC household data; decomposed EU income-inequality trends into tax, transfer and composition components.

Bocconi University Milan, Italy

Research Intern, Junior Researchers Grant (Prof. Z. Parolin) Apr 2022 – Sep 2022

- Designed survey sampling for gig-economy workers across EU member states; built a multi-source database combining US Census, administrative and private-sector data.

PUBLICATIONS AND WORKING PAPERS

- Filauro, S., Parolin, Z. & Valetto, P. (2025). *What explains recent trends in income inequality in the European Union?* The Journal of Economic Inequality.
- Valetto, P., Filauro, S., Marx, I. & Gornick, J. C. (2026). *Real Estate Wealth Is Not a Monolith: Non-Primary Real Estate and Its Role in Wealth Concentration.* Under review, The Journal of Economic Inequality. Stone Center Working Paper No. 127, CUNY Graduate Center.
- Valetto, P. (2026). *Magnificent for Whom? The Impact of the AI Equity Boom on U.S. Wealth Concentration.* Under review, Economics Letters.
- Valetto, P. & Marx, I. (2025). *Asset Testing in Social Transfer and Welfare Programs in High-Income Countries: A Systematic Review.* SocArXiv; Stone Center Working Paper, CUNY Graduate Center.
- Goodger, S., Valetto, P. & Kuiper, E. (2026). *Fostering AI Resilience in the EU Labour Market.* Policy Brief, European Policy Centre.

Work in progress: *Generative AI, Labour Market Risk and Worker Perceptions in Europe* (with Z. Parolin); *Canaries in the (European) Coal Mine? Generative AI and Early-Career Employment in the EU-LFS.*

Commentary (Social Europe): *AI's Impact on Europe's Job Market: A Call for a Social Compact* (with F. Pozzi); *The European Union's Road to Abundance* (2025); *Social Europe against all odds — but is it enough?* (with H. Haapanala).

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

- **Popular Economics** (popularеconomics.substack.com): founder and author of a newsletter and video series explaining economic research and policy to a general audience.
- **EU Iran-War Fuel Cost Tracker** (pietrovaletto.github.io/tracker): open-data tracker of the extra fuel cost to EU households, updated weekly from the EC Oil Bulletin and Eurostat.

SKILLS

- **Methods:** difference-in-differences and event studies; RDD, synthetic control, propensity-score matching; RCT evaluation; RIF and Oaxaca–Blinder decomposition; Gini source decomposition; tax–benefit and labour-market microsimulation; multiple imputation with replicate-weight bootstrap; wild-cluster bootstrap inference.
- **Data:** EU-SILC and EU-LFS (multi-country, multi-wave; ISCO-08 linkage to task and AI-exposure indices), HFCS, LWS/LIS (LISSY); US: SCF, CPS, CES, OEWS, ACS.
- **Programming:** Stata (advanced), Python (pandas, data pipelines), R; AI-assisted development (Claude Code, Cursor).
- **Languages:** Italian and English (native).